

Creating Accessible Multimedia Presentations

For multimedia presentations, you should synchronize equivalent text with the presentation itself. Synchronizing equivalent information with a presentation is the same concept as using captions for a television movie. The text equivalent of the animation is presented on screen. The animation and the text equivalent are synchronized, so that the text equivalent describes the animation.

When you synchronize presentations in the same way for Web content, you are assisting people with vision and hearing difficulties. For people with visual impairments, the screen reader interprets the animation. For people with hearing impairments, the text version adequately describes the animation and the sound.

Because people accessing your Web content might have visual and hearing impairments, make your content describe the animation and the sound accurately. For example, be sure to describe noises that indicate the tone or mood of the animation, like a door slamming or a crowd cheering.

Creating Accessible Applets

In some cases, multimedia presentations require user input and cannot be replicated in an alternative format. For example, a mathematics program allows students to enter numbers and perform calculations. When providing equivalent text is not possible, make the applet accessible. You can make an applet accessible by providing descriptive text in the element content.

Allowing Additional Time

Multimedia presentations should allow a viewer additional time, if requested, to process information. One method of allowing the user additional time to view information is to use a scrolling text applet that allows the user the option to read the message in static form. To see an example of such an applet, visit trace.wisc.edu/world/java/scrolltext.html.